

Garlic Parmesan Chicken Meatballs with Orzo

PREP: 10 MINS | COOK: 35 MINS | SERVINGS: 4

"The ultimate cosy, creamy, garlicky dinner that feels indulgent but is still easy enough for a weeknight. Juicy chicken meatballs infused with herbs and cheese, simmered in a rich, silky one-pan orzo sauce."

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE MEATBALLS

- **500 g** chicken mince
- **80 g** fine breadcrumbs
- **30 g** grated Parmesan
- **1** egg
- **1 tsp** Dijon mustard
- **1 tsp** honey
- **1 tsp** garlic granules
- **1 tsp** paprika
- **1 tsp** oregano
- **Juice of** ½ lemon
- **1 bulb** roasted garlic
(or 1 tbsp roasted garlic paste)
- **5 g** fresh parsley (finely chopped)
- **1 tsp** olive oil (+ 1 tbsp for frying)

FOR THE SAUCE & ORZO

- **300 g** orzo
- **1** shallot (diced)
- **3 cloves** garlic (minced)
- **100 ml** white wine (optional)
- **300 ml** double cream
- **600 ml** chicken stock
- ½ **tsp** Dijon mustard
- **1 tsp** paprika

INSTRUCTIONS

STEP 1: PREP THE MEATBALLS

In a large bowl, combine all of the meatball ingredients until well mixed. Carefully roll the seasoned mixture into uniform small balls to ensure quick and even cooking.

STEP 2: SEAR THE MEATBALLS

Heat 1 tablespoon of olive oil in a large saucepan over medium to high heat. Add the chicken meatballs and fry, turning regularly, until golden brown on all sides and cooked completely through (approx. 10–15 minutes). Carefully remove the meatballs from the pan and set aside.

STEP 3: BUILD THE FLAVOR BASE

In the same pan, melt a little butter and add the diced shallot. Sauté until softened, then add the minced garlic and cook briefly until fragrant. Stir in the paprika, oregano, and dry orzo, thoroughly coating the pasta in the aromatic butter and spices. Pour in the white wine (if using) and allow it to bubble for a minute to deglaze and lift the caramelized bits from the bottom of the pan.

STEP 4: SIMMER THE ORZO

Pour in the double cream, Dijon mustard, and most of the chicken stock so the orzo is fully submerged. Cover and simmer for 5 minutes, stirring halfway through. Uncover, stir well, and add the remaining stock. Nestle the seared chicken meatballs back into the pan. Cover again and simmer for an additional 5 minutes until the orzo is tender and beautifully saucy.

- **1 tsp** oregano
- **30 g** Parmesan (grated)
- **5 g** fresh parsley (chopped)
- **Zest of** ½ lemon
- Salt and pepper (to taste)

STEP 5: FINISH AND SERVE

Finish the dish by sprinkling over the grated Parmesan, fresh lemon zest, and finely chopped parsley. Stir gently and cook for a final few minutes on low heat until the sauce becomes glossy, rich, and creamy. Serve immediately.

CHEF'S TOP TIP & NOTES

Do not overmix: Gently combining the meatball ingredients keeps the chicken light and prevents it from turning dense. Light handling traps air, giving you incredibly soft, juicy meatballs.

Deep Searing: Getting a deep golden crust on the meatballs locks in juices and provides delicious caramelized bits that add deep umami richness directly into the orzo sauce during deglazing.